

PFFP 302: PERSONAL FINANCE MANAGEMENT – Money Skills for Financial Success

An Exploring Perspectives & Quantitative Reasoning Gen Ed Course

COURSE SYLLABUS

FALL 2025

Instructor:	Patrick Payne, PhD	Class Days:	Monday, Wednesday
Office:	McClelland Park 301F	Class Times:	ASYNCHRONOUS
Phone:	520-626-5374 (UA office)	Class Location:	D2L
Email:	ppayne@arizona.edu (best way to contact)	First/Last days of class:	Aug 25 – Dec 11
Office Link:	https://arizona.zoom.us/j/4205089352	Final Project Due Date:	Sun, Dec 11th @ 11:59 p.m. (no final exam)

Teaching Assistants:	see D2L for teaching team contact information
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Introduction

Introduce yourself to your students with a welcome message about the course and how to use the syllabus.

Course Description

This course is designed to familiarize students with the fundamental principles and tools used by economic scientists to analyze the personal and family financial issues that affect people's quality of life. Course topics will include an analysis of personal financial information resources the concept of the time-value of money, discussion of personal financial issues concerning the economic environment, financial statements, college planning, career planning, tax, credit, housing, insurance, retirement and estate planning, and investments.

Course Materials

Required Textbook. Master of Money Course Pack, available at www.MidasClassroom.com.

Expected Students Learning Outcomes

General Education Student Learning Outcomes

Students will identify the approaches and methodologies of the **Social Scientists** perspective, use evidence and/or knowledge generated within the disciplinary perspective to critically analyze questions, ideas, and/or arguments, and describe contributions of this perspective to finding solutions to global and/or local challenges.

Students will demonstrate competency in working with numerical information by critically analyzing quantitative information, generating ideas that are supported by quantitative evidence, assessing the relevance of data and its associated implications in a variety of contexts, and communicating those ideas and/or associated interpretations using various formats (graphs, data tables, equations, oral presentations, or written reflections).

Expected Student Learning Outcomes

1. Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of the interconnection of personal and family spending habits, and the global impact on quality of life;
2. Apply strategic financial planning and management of financial resources in achieving personal and family financial goals and objectives;
3. Analyze cause and effect of financing strategies and consumer behavior of spending, saving, and planning for college education, professional careers, retirement, risk management, and estate planning;

Course Objectives

During this course, students will...

- Demonstrate an understanding of the approaches and methodologies used by economists to analyze personal financial choices including utility theory, lifecycle theory, the time value of money, personal preferences, and broader societal forces such as taxes and legal constraints.
- Explain the concept of borrowing and perform cost/benefit calculations to make justifiable recommendations regarding all types of borrowing decisions, such as credit cards, mortgages, vehicle loans, and student loans.
- Explore the concepts of saving and investing and integrate cost/benefit calculations into fundamental investment decisions such as how, when, where, and how much to invest.
- Recognize, assess, and manage risk and uncertainty in a financial plan and mediate the effects of risk through proper evaluation of both insurance products and other techniques.
- Perform essential economic calculations and critically analyze the quantitative results of such calculations to form and effectively communicate practical recommendations and best practices for a wide range of personal financial choices.

Course Assessment Plan

Learning Opportunities Throughout the course

The expected learning outcomes of the class will be achieved by providing students with opportunities to develop each of the three facets of financial literacy. These three facets, and the means of teaching and assessing them, are presented below.

- **Knowledge.** Knowledge refers to an understanding of terminology, rules, and basic concepts related to financial decisions. In this course, knowledge is conveyed through the pre-recorded lectures and provided reading materials.
- **Skills.** Financial skills refers to the ability to analyze a problem or situation mathematically to determine the costs and benefits. Skills will be developed

through the use of practice quizzes and math skills quizzes.

- **Critical thinking**. Critical thinking is the ability to make effective decisions by using knowledge and skills to identify an optimal solution to a financial situation. Critical thinking more strongly determines your final grade than does either knowledge or skill, as it incorporates them both. We will practice developing critical thinking skills through the case study and will demonstrate critical thinking skills in their individual reflection essays and the final essay.

The expected learning outcomes for the course will be evaluated through the following:

- Skills Quiz: Each unit of the course will have a short quiz to assess development of mathematical financial skills expected from all students in the course. Each skill quiz also has a practice quiz that allows unlimited attempts to practice your math skills.
- Lecture Quiz: Each recorded lecture has a brief quiz that you must take after watching the video.
- Final Essay: A final essay assignment will be provided at the beginning of the course. Students are expected to demonstrate basic knowledge from the course as well as their ability to think critically about how the materials in the class can be applied in their own personal lives.

Signature Assignment and ePortfolio

Students will be assigned to groups for a collaborative case study project during the first week of class. This assignment serves as the signature assignment in this course and is designed to integrate the diverse perspectives and ideas of the group. The project will be submitted in four parts, with each part corresponding to one unit of the course and due before its associated unit closes.

Throughout the semester, group participation will be assessed through individual reflections. These reflections will provide an opportunity for each student to evaluate their contributions to the group, the effectiveness of collaboration, and the value of perspective-taking in achieving project goals. Students will also analyze the use of financial literacy concepts and tools within their group's work, linking their reflections to their learning and growth.

The final, comprehensive case study document must be submitted by 11:59 pm on Sunday December 10th.

In the new General Education curriculum you will include signature assignments in your final ePortfolio in Digication. Uploading your Signature Financial Plan to your Digication ePortfolio will make UNIV 301 more useful. This does not apply to students in the Tiers General Education curriculum.

Final Examination or Project

There is no final examination for this course.

Honors Credit

The Honors contract for this course is an additional case study. The case study for the main course is for a fictional individual. The Honor's contract will require you to complete all aspects of the case study again, but this time for yourself in your actual expected circumstances upon graduation. Detailed information on this contract can be obtained on D2L.

Scheduled Topics/Activities

The schedule below outlines the course path through the curriculum. Due dates are also listed in D2L.

Unit 1: Basics - Foundations of Personal Financial Planning		
Week 1	Course Intro The Life Cycle Money Personalities	2.1, 1.1, 1.3
Week 2	Time Value of Money Financial Statements Financial Ratios	1.2, 1.4 2.2
Week 3	Taxes	2.3, 2.4
Week 4	Unit Wrap-up	
Unit 2: Borrowing - Using Your Future Income Today		
Week 5	Credit Reports and Scores Credit Cards Student Loans	3.1, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4
Week 6	Housing Mortgages	4.2, 4.3
Week 7	Vehicles	4.1
Week 8	Unit Wrap-up	
Unit 3: Investing - The Risk and Reward of Delayed Gratification		
Week 9	Intro to Investing Human Capital	5.1, 5.2
Week 10	Risk and Return Human Capital	5.3, 5.4
Week 11	Investment Strategies Retirement Plans	6.1 6.2
Week 12	Unit Wrap-up	
Unit 4: Protecting - Yourself, Your Stuff, and the People You Love		
Week 13	Intro to risk management Health Insurance	7.1, 7.2
Week 14	Liability Insurance	7.3, 7.4
Week 15	Life Insurance	7.5

Week 16 Unit Wrap-up

Part 2: Course Information

Instructor(s) and Course Sites

See top of Syllabus.

Course Communications

I will do my best to respond as soon as possible and within 24 hours during the week. Weekend response times may be slower. Office hours are by appointment because this is the easiest way to accommodate your schedules and my own. I encourage you to set an appointment if you'd like to discuss something about the course.

Course Format and Session Structure

This class is scheduled to be taught in the online modality. As such, there will be no in - person class meetings. All materials are posted to the class D2L site.

2.4 Required Resources and Equipment

List any texts, supplies, tools/devices, and minimum technologies students have to acquire or loan on their own to engage with the course.

- Optional: List materials, tools, and supplies that will be made available by the instructor and university, e.g., resources shared via D2L or the UA Libraries.
- Optional: List any recommended texts, tools, and supplies and indicate whether the university can provide for them or not.
- Optional: List minimum technical skills required for the course, outline what technical support may be integrated into the course, and provide campus resources for technical support.

2.5 Student Success Resources

The University of Arizona provides many resources and support services for students. Students are encouraged to consider all of the support resources linked below:

- [UA Academic policies and procedures](#)
- [Student Assistance and Advocacy information](#)
- [Counseling and Psych Services \(CAPS\)](#)
- [Other student support resources](#)

Part 3: Course Policies

While UA Policies apply to all courses, most courses have some course-specific policies. This segment differentiates between policies pertaining to course progress and completion and those pertaining to the classroom climate and community engagement.

3.1 Progress and Completion Policies

Late Enrollment

Statement on whether students who register after the first class meeting may make up missed assignments/quizzes and the deadline for doing so.

Absence and Class Participation

Fundamental to success in any class is simply showing up. With this in mind, it is required that you attend class regularly. Missing a class should be a rare occurrence; something that happens no more than three (3) times throughout the entire semester. If you miss class more than this, it will interfere with your learning, and more than likely will negatively affect your overall performance and your final grade for the course. Besides, unexcused absences in excess of three (3) will have a detrimental effect on the points awarded for "Professionalism/ Participation."

Note: Should a situation arise and a student miss a quiz, discussion question, written assignment, group work, etc., a "0" will be assigned for the particular assessment. The only time a make-up will be provided for a missed assessment will be for an "excused" absence, with such absence to be limited to: (a) all holidays or special events by organized religions, provided students illustrate affiliation with such religion; or b) any absence discussed in advance with the instructor.

The UA's policies concerning Class Attendance and Participation is available at:

<https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-and-participation>.

The UA policy regarding absences for any sincerely held religious belief, observance or practice will be accommodated where reasonable,

<http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy>(link is external).

Absences for groups of more than three students that are pre-approved by the UA Dean of Students (or Dean Designee) will be honored.

See: <http://policy.arizona.edu/employmenthuman-resources/attendance> (link is external).

Late Submissions and Revisions

All tasks that require submission through D2L have an availability period. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that all tasks are completed AND submitted before the end of the availability period. Assignments submitted after the due date will be subject to a 10% penalty per day unless the students provides a university excused absence. The availability periods in this class are pre-programmed at the beginning of the semester and will not be changed, so please plan accordingly.

Grading

Students will be responsible for successfully completing eight (8) practice quizzes (10 points each for a total of 80 points), eight (8) skills quizzes (20 points each for a total of 160 points), eight (8) lecture quizzes (10 points each for a total of 160 points), four (4) case study assignments (100 points each for a total of 400 points), four (4) individual reflections (25 points each for a total of 100 points), and a final essay worth 100 points. Final course grades, based on a total of 1,000 points, will be determined as follows:

Grading by Assignment Type		Grading Scale
Practice Quizzes (10 points each)	80	A = 90%+
Skills Quizzes (20 points each)	160	B = 80%-89%

Lecture Quizzes (10 points each)	160	C = 70% - 79%
Case Study Assignments (100 points each)	400	D = 60% - 69%
Individual Reflections (20 points each)	60	E = < 60%
Final Essay	40	
Total	900	

Requests for [incomplete \(I\)](#) or [withdrawal \(W\)](#) must be made in accordance with University policies.

If you wish to dispute a grade, you must do so within 7 calendar days from the day the grade was posted to D2L.

Classroom Climate and Community Engagement

UA Policies and Student Resources

All UA courses adhere to the general UA Policies as stated on the institutional websites: <https://academicaffairs.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies>. Please make yourself familiar with the Student Code of Academic Integrity and the protocol ensuring non-discriminatory, anti-harassment, non-threatening learning experiences. This site also includes a list of student resources. The entirety of University Policies can be found here: <https://catalog.arizona.edu/policies>.

Accessibility and Accommodations:

The goal for this course is that learning experiences be as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience barriers based on disability, please contact the Disability Resource Center (520-621-3268) to establish reasonable accommodations. For additional information on the Disability Resource Center and reasonable accommodations, please visit the DRC Website (opens a new window).

If you have reasonable accommodations, please reach out to discuss your needs and how course requirements and activities can be adjusted to ensure your ability to participate.

Inclusive Excellence is a fundamental part of the University of Arizona's strategic plan and culture. As part of this initiative, the institution embraces and practices diversity and inclusiveness. These values are expected, respected, and welcomed in this course.

Preferred Gender Pronouns: This course affirms people of all gender expressions and gender identities. Please reach out to share your preferred pronouns and name, if they differ from the class roster. If you wish to change your preferred name or pronouns in the UAccess system, please visit the Office of the Registrar's guide to updating personal information (opens a new window).

Life challenges: Please reach out to your instructor if there are accommodations that you feel would help you succeed in this course. If you are experiencing unexpected barriers to your success in your courses, please note the Dean of Students Office is a central support resource for all students and may be helpful. The Dean of Students Office can be reached at 520-621-2057 or DOS-deanofstudents@email.arizona.edu.

Physical and mental health challenges: If you are facing physical or mental health challenges this semester, please note that Campus Health provides quality medical and mental health care. For medical appointments, call (520) 621-9202. For After Hours care, call (520) 570- 7898. Learn more at the [Campus Health Website \(opens a new window\)](#). For the Counseling & Psych Services (CAPS) 24/7 hotline, call (520) 621- 3334. Learn more at the [CAPS Website \(opens a new window\)](#)

Additional support resources for students:

- [The Advising Resource Center links students to their academic advisors. Learn more at the Advising Resource Center Website \(opens a new window\)](#).
- [The Writing Center offers free tutoring and workshops. Learn more at the Think Tank Writing Center Website \(opens a new window\)](#).
- [The Thrive Center offers numerous programs to help students successfully navigate their experiences at the University of Arizona. Learn more at the Thrive Center Website \(opens a new window\)](#).
- [The Campus Pantry provides free access to food staples for students in need. Learn more at the Campus Pantry Website \(opens a new window\)](#).
- [The Survivor Advocacy Program provides confidential support and advocacy services to student survivors of sexual and gender-based violence. The Program can also advise students about relevant non-UA resources available within the local community for support. Learn more at the Survivor Advocacy Website \(opens a new window\)](#).
- [Wildcat RISE provides free mental health support in the form of one- on-one and group sessions led by trained peer leaders. Learn more at the Wildcat RISE Website \(opens a new window\)](#).
- [Support.Outreach.Success: Need help and unsure where to turn? Reach out to an SOS Specialist at \[sos@arizona.edu\]\(mailto:sos@arizona.edu\). Learn more here: \[UArizona Student Support Resources \\(opens a new window\\)\]\(#\)](#).

Additional Policies

Plagiarism and Academic Integrity:

Students are encouraged to share intellectual views and discuss freely the principles and applications of course materials. However, graded work/exercises must be the product of independent effort unless otherwise instructed. Students are expected to adhere to the UArizona Code of Academic Integrity at all times. See: [Dean of Students Code of Academic Integrity \(opens a new window\)](#)

Note that BOTH students who copy another student's work AND students who knowingly share their own work will be in violation of the Code of Academic Integrity and will face repercussions. Should a student's paper reflect the work of another, a failing grade will be issued for the particular assignment, and the student will be referred to the Dean of Student's Office for disciplinary action as mandated under the UA Code of Academic Integrity.

UArizona Nondiscrimination and Anti-harassment Policy:

The University is committed to creating and maintaining an environment free of discrimination. In support of this commitment, the University prohibits discrimination, including harassment and retaliation, based on a protected classification, including race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, sexual orientation,

gender identity, or genetic information. For more information, including how to report a concern, please see the UArizona Nondiscrimination and Antiharassment Policy ([opens a new window](#)).

UArizona Threatening Behavior by Students Policy:

This policy prohibits threats of physical harm to any member of the University community, including to oneself. See: UArizona Threatening Behavior by Students Policy ([opens a new window](#))

UArizona Disruptive Behavior in an Instructional Setting Policy: Students creating disturbances that interfere with the conduct of the class or the learning of others are in violation of the Student Code of Conduct and may be referred to the Dean of Students Office. See: UArizona Disruptive Behavior Policy ([opens a new window](#))

Confidentiality of Student Records

Student records are protected by the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974 (FERPA). For more information, visit the Office of the Registrar's FERPA Compliance webpage here: [FERPA policy](#).

Subject to Change Statement

Information contained in the course syllabus, other than the grade and absence policy, may be subject to change with advance notice, as deemed appropriate by the instructor.